

Voluntary Work Report



Submitted by

Ayesha Iftiaz

Roll no: 044638

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Ms. Lubna Shirreen

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Department of Applied Psychology

Govt. Graduate College of Women, Baghbanpura, Lahore.

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Time Management Skill Development

1.1 Introduction

The concept of Managing time can be pragmatic in that it is subliminally tied towards achieving the objective(s) or goal(s), whether on an individual or collective scale. Time is finite and cannot be manufactured - it is a finite resource that we have to manage (Decker, 2011). Time is so subtle that it cannot be saved, but can only be spent, and once misused, it can never be regained. Whether it is the management of an organization to foster development and/or effectuate improvement, or an individual looking for better ways to spend time, time management is important to both.

According to Ojo and Olaniran (2008), the attributes of time are that time is a unique resource; time is the scarcest resource in the universe; time cannot be replaced by man; **time cannot be accumulated like money**; time cannot be turned on and off like machine; time cannot be stocked like raw materials; time passes at a pre-determined rate whatever happens; everybody is equally endowed with the same amount of it irrespective of position.

Like any other scarce resource, time must be managed and used judiciously. It may seem somewhat unreasonable to consecrate valuable time in the erudition of time management, rather than just going straight ahead to get on with our daily activities. On the contrary, the benefits of time management are enormous.

1.2 Time Management

The phrase time management comprises of two words 'time' and 'management'. According to the World English Dictionary, *Time* refers to the continuous passage of existence in which events pass from a state of potentiality in

the future, through the present, to a state of finality in the past. *Management* on the other hand, refers to a multipurpose organ that oversees business, and oversees managers, and oversees workers, and work.

According to Irikefe (2017), the skills that will enable an individual to manage time effectively and efficiently are what is referred to as "time management skills.

Arising from the definitions of 'time' and 'management', it can be inferred time management is simply the process of organizing and planning **how** to divide and arrange your schedule amongst specific undertakings to maximize effectiveness in Roles, Importance, and Benefit of Time Management in achieving Organizational Objectives efficient manner. At work, time management is one of the most important skills anybody can have. (Drucker, 1954)



1.3 Importance of Time Management

Time management is crucial for achieving success and maintaining a balanced life.

- By effectively managing our time, we can prioritize tasks, set goals, and make the most of each day.
- It allows us to be more organized, productive, and efficient in our daily activities.
- With proper time management, we can reduce stress, avoid procrastination, and meet deadlines.
- It also helps us create a sense of discipline and control over our lives.
- Time is a **limited resource**, and by managing it wisely, we can maximize our productivity, achieve our goals, and have more time for the things that truly matter to us.

1.4 Effective Time Management Tips

Effective time management is essential and challenging. But recognizing and addressing common issues can significantly improve productivity, well-being, and achieving your goals. Some strategies to enhance time-management skills and common time-management challenges and how to tackle them are the following:

1.4.1 Prioritize Tasks

- Identify urgent and important tasks. Use techniques like the Eisenhower Matrix to categorize tasks into four quadrants: urgent and important, important but not urgent, urgent but not important, and neither urgent nor important.
- Focus on high-priority items first.

1.4.2 Set Clear Goals

- Define specific, measurable goals. Break them down into smaller steps.

- Regularly review your progress and adjust as needed.
- Motivate yourself by setting clear goals and understanding the purpose behind your tasks.

- Celebrate small achievements to boost motivation and maintain momentum.

1.4.3 Create a Schedule

- Allocate time blocks for different activities. Use tools like calendars or digital planners.

- Stick to your schedule and avoid overcommitting.

1.4.4 Avoid Multitasking

- Concentrate on one task at a time. Multitasking can reduce efficiency and increase errors.
- Instead, practice single-tasking by dedicating your attention to one task at a time.

- Switching between tasks consumes mental energy and reduces overall productivity.

1.4.5 Use Time Blocks

- Implement the Pomodoro Technique: Work for 25 minutes, then take a 5-minute break. Repeat this cycle.
- Adjust the time intervals based on your preferences.
- Skipping breaks can lead to burnout. Regular breaks improve focus and creativity.

1.4.6 Minimize Distractions

- Frequent distractions can disrupt your workflow. Identify common distractions (like social media or notifications) and create a distraction-free work environment.

- Set specific times for checking emails or messages to avoid constant interruptions.

1.4.7 Learn to Say No

- Politely decline tasks that don't align with your priorities.

- Saying no allows you to protect your time and energy.

1.4.8 Delegate When Possible

- Trust others with tasks that can be handled by someone else.
- Delegating frees up your time for more critical responsibilities.

1.4.9 Low Motivation:

- Sometimes, finding the motivation to complete important tasks can be the first obstacle to good time management.
- If you're feeling unmotivated, try identifying something about the task that does interest you. Focus on that part of the project.

- For example, if you're relocating shelves of files, think about the exciting new projects that will occupy the newly opened space.



1.5 Benefits of Time Management

Effective time management offers several benefits that can positively impact

on life.

- **Decreased Stress:** Managing your time reduces stress levels. By scheduling tasks and allowing room for unexpected issues, you can remain calm even when faced with challenges.
- **Increased Productivity:** Mastering time management helps you complete tasks more efficiently. You'll notice quicker task completion and reduced stress about deadlines.
- **Positive Reputation:** Staying on schedule makes you reliable. Coworkers and employers appreciate your consistency, leading to career advancement and better workplace satisfaction.
- **More Energy for Free Time:** Knowing when tasks will be completed saves energy. Plan breaks and enjoy your free time without worrying about unfinished work.
- **Clear Daily Goals:** Time management helps set clear goals for each day. Prioritize tasks and stay focused on what matters most.
- **Improved Focus:** Organizing your time enhances concentration. You'll tackle tasks with better attention and efficiency.
- **Streamlined Decision-Making:** Time management allows you to make decisions based on priorities. You'll choose wisely and avoid unnecessary delays.
- **Reaching Goals Faster:** Efficiently managing time accelerates progress toward your goals, both personally and professionally.

1.6 Objective

- Develop effective time management skills
- Prioritize tasks and manage deadlines
- Improve productivity and efficiency
- Enhance goal achievement

1.7 Procedure

After receiving permission from the institutional authority, they assigned me class 9th for my lecture. I educate participants by providing them with information about the importance of time management skills including its benefits and challenges. First, I introduce myself and then my objective to providing them knowledge about time management.



Ask students about their current time management habits and challenges. I also expose them to proper methods for coping with the challenges related to time management. Time management helps to avoid stress, improve focus, and increase productivity.

I also teach them some simple techniques to avoid anxiety and motivate them to develop these skills in them for being more productive. I educate them about the timewasting and time saving activities. I ask to perform some quick activities related to time management like creating the schedule, prioritizing the tasks, and dividing the task in small pieces.

Time Management Puzzle: "The Busy Day" in which "Prioritize tasks and manage time effectively to complete all activities within a limited time frame."

Instructions

1. You have 60 minutes to complete the following tasks:

- Task A: Study for a math test (30 minutes)
- Task B: Write a short essay (20 minutes)
- Task C: Meet with a friend (10 minutes)
- Task D: Practice a English tense (20 minutes)
- Task E: Take a short break (10 minutes)

2. You can only work on one task at a time.
3. Each task has a specific time constraint, and you must complete each task within that time frame.
4. If you don't complete a task within the allotted time, it will be carried over to the next time slot.
5. Your goal is to complete all tasks within the 60-minute.

Challenge

- Task A and Task D require simultaneous attention (e.g., you need to study math while practicing English tense).

- Task B and Task C have conflicting time slots (e.g., your friend can only meet during the same time as the essay writing).
- Task E can only be taken after completing Task A.



Solution

- Prioritize tasks based on importance and urgency.
- Allocate time slots for each task, considering the conflicts and requirements.
- Manage your time effectively to complete all tasks within the 60-minute time frame.

Debriefing

- Ask students to share their solutions and how they prioritized tasks.
- Discuss the challenges faced and how they managed their time.
- Emphasize the importance of prioritization, time management, and adaptability in real-life scenarios.

This puzzle simulates real-life scenarios, where tasks have conflicting requirements, and time management skills are essential to achieve goals. By solving this puzzle, students will develop their critical thinking, prioritization, and time management skills. At the end I have a short question-answer session with the students who attend the lecture I tried my best to encourage the active participation of all the participants and also in the end of the sessions asked for feedback from the individual or participants.

1.8 Time Management Activities

Working on time management is a valuable and practical area to focus on.

Following activities related to time management techniques:

1. **Time Audit:** Have the students track their daily activities for a week and identify time-wasting activities or areas for improvement.
2. **Prioritization Exercise:** Provide the students with a list of tasks and ask them to prioritize them based on importance and urgency.
3. **Pomodoro Technique:** Introduce the Pomodoro Technique, where students work in focused 25-minute intervals followed by short breaks, to improve productivity.
4. **Goal Setting:** Guide the students in setting SMART (Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound) goals to help them effectively manage their time.
5. **Time Blocking:** Teach the students how to use time blocking to allocate specific time slots for different tasks or activities throughout the day.

These activities will help the students develop essential time management

skills that they can apply in their studies and beyond.

1. **Mindfulness Exercises:** Teach the students mindfulness techniques, such as deep breathing or meditation, to help them stay focused and present in the moment while managing their time.

2. **Self-Reflection Journaling:** Encourage the students to keep a journal where they reflect on their time management practices, identify patterns, and explore strategies for improvement.

3. **Time Perception Experiment:** Conduct an activity where students estimate the duration of different tasks or activities, and then compare their estimates to the actual time taken. This can help them become more aware of how they perceive and utilize time.

4. **Procrastination Challenge:** Create a challenge where students track and try to minimize their procrastination tendencies. They can share strategies for overcoming procrastination and support each other in staying on track.

5. **Group Time Management Project:** Assign a group project where students work collaboratively to manage their time effectively. This can involve setting deadlines, dividing tasks, and monitoring progress. It helps them learn teamwork and time management simultaneously.

These activities will not only enhance their time management skills but also promote self-awareness, reflection, and collaboration.

1.9 Conclusion

In conclusion, our voluntary work on time management skill development has been a rewarding experience for both the students and me. Through interactive sessions and activities, I have empowered 9th standard students with essential time

management skills, enabling them to prioritize tasks, create schedules, and achieve their goals. I observed a significant improvement in the students' understanding of time management concepts and their ability to apply them in real-life situations. The interactive puzzle activity demonstrated the importance of prioritization, adaptability, and effective time allocation.

As volunteers, I gained valuable experience in communicating complex concepts in a simple and engaging manner. I also developed our skills in lesson planning, delivery, and assessment. I believe that the skills imparted through this voluntary work will have a lasting impact on the students' academic performance, personal productivity, and overall well-being. I hope that our efforts will inspire the students to continue practicing effective time management and achieve their full potential.

1.10 Recommendation

As I conclude our voluntary work on time management, I recommend that the students continue to apply the techniques they've learned in future projects. Doing so will allow them to manage their time more efficiently, achieve their goals, and reduce stress. Additionally, I encourage them to share their knowledge and skills with their peers, fostering a culture of productivity and teamwork. Finally, I advise them to set realistic goals and deadlines, avoiding overcommitting and ensuring a healthy work-life balance. By following these recommendations, the students will be well-equipped to excel in their academic and professional pursuits and positively impact their communities.

- Continue to use time management techniques in future projects: This recommendation encourages students to apply the skills they've learned to future tasks and projects, reinforcing good time management habits.
- Share knowledge and skills with others to enhance team productivity: By sharing their knowledge, students can help their peers improve their time management skills, leading to more efficient teamwork and **better outcomes**.
- Set realistic goals and deadlines to avoid overcommitting: This recommendation advises students to be mindful of their capacity and avoid taking on too much, ensuring they can deliver quality work and maintain their well-being.

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